



Sloths feed only on leaves from a small variety of trees



Underwater pasture

Marine iguanas from the Galápagos Islands are some of the world's strangest plant-eating animals. Instead of feeding on the shore, they dive into the sea to graze on underwater seaweed beds. The iguanas use their rudderlike tails for swimming and resist the pull of the water by clinging to rocks with their sharp claws. Although the Galápagos Islands lie on the equator, the sea around them is cold. After grazing, marine iguanas return to land and bask in the sunshine. This raises their body temperature and helps them to digest their food.

Fur forms peaks, helping rainwater run off body during feeding

Bamboo feasting

The giant panda is a bear that has taken up a vegetarian diet. Uniquely for a bear, it feeds almost entirely on bamboo, even though it still has the teeth of a meat-eater. The panda's flat paws have a specially extended wrist bone that works like a movable, or opposable, thumb, and grips bamboo stems. Compared to other plant-eaters, the panda is not very efficient at digesting its food, and so it must eat up to 90 lb (40 kg) of bamboo a day.

Extended wrist bone closes against panda's true thumb when it is holding stems

